

A polished personal essay on neurodivergence, faith, meaning, and learning.

Estimated read: 4–6 minutes

The Argument in My Head: Brain, Heart, and Soul

Some days my ADHD and autism don't feel like diagnoses so much as a *committee meeting* I didn't ask to attend.

In my head, three voices take turns at the mic:

- **Brain** speaks in urgency.
- **Heart** speaks in growth.
- **Soul** speaks in surrender.

They don't always agree—but lately I've been realizing they might all be telling the truth, just from different angles.

Brain: The Survival Voice

My brain opens the session with a warning:

The world is in tatters. Time is running. We're getting older. Why keep taking classes? None of this gets us closer to Jannah.

It's not laziness. It's protection.

When the world feels unstable, my mind demands **meaning**, **urgency**, and **proof** that my effort matters.

Heart: The Human-Growth Voice

My heart answers back—soft, but stubborn:

Learning isn't for other people's expectations. It's for growth. It's for the lifelong search for knowledge—skimming and combing through ideas that outlive us.

I think about writers and thinkers who lived long before I ever existed—Einstein, Poe, Lovecraft, Hawking, Tolkien—people whose work still reaches across time like mentorship.

My heart keeps reminding me: learning is how I stay awake in the world.

Soul: The Surrender Voice

And then my soul—quiet, almost amused—offers something steadier:

It matters not what you learn or don't learn. God will ensure you maintain the information you need when the time comes. We can only walk as far as the light illuminates in the vast darkness of the unknown.

This voice doesn't demand certainty. It asks for trust.

The Question Underneath It All

If I'm honest, I don't know who to listen to all the time.

Time and space feel infinite. My life can feel small in comparison. And when the world looks too chaotic, "small" starts to sound like "meaningless."

So the question keeps circling back:

What is my overall purpose here?

What I've Already Lived Through

When I zoom out, I can't call my life meaningless—not with a straight face.

I fell in love. I got married.

I broke a cycle that wanted to repeat itself through me: toxic, dysfunctional, abusive family patterns that felt like inheritance. I uprooted that family tree and planted a new garden somewhere safer.

I spent years trying to heal—childhood, teen years, adulthood—because trauma doesn't stay in the past. It travels. It asks to be carried. And at some point, you decide whether it gets a permanent room in your house, or whether it becomes something you learn to live with *without letting it run the place*.

There were other battles too—private ones that reshaped me—and we made it through.

I raised a child. I watched a beautiful little baby boy turn into a whole person, nearly overnight—someone with opinions, momentum, and a future. In a few years he'll be driving, going to college, living his new life.

And when I look ahead, I feel this strange quiet opening.

Like the loudest chapters are behind me.

So what's left?

Study Qur'an and wait for Allah (Swt) to call me home?

Why Learning Can Feel Like a Threat

Here's what I'm starting to understand: the part of me that calls learning “a waste of time” isn't lazy.

It's afraid.

When the world feels unstable, my brain wants a guarantee that effort will pay off. It wants my time to be **immediately meaningful**, not just meaningful *eventually*.

But my heart doesn't ask for guarantees. It asks for life.

And my soul doesn't argue at all—it simply reminds me I don't have to control the entire story. I only have to walk the part in front of me.

What If None of Them Are Wrong?

What if my brain, heart, and soul aren't enemies—just voices speaking at different altitudes?

- **Brain** speaks from the world: danger, urgency, limited time.
- **Heart** speaks from the journey: curiosity, legacy, becoming.
- **Soul** speaks from destiny: trust, surrender, divine timing.

I don't think I need to silence any of them.

I think I need to *integrate* them.

And the bridge between them might be learning itself—not as a performance, not as a hustle, not as a way to prove anything to anybody.

Learning as preparation.

Learning as worship.

Learning as stewardship of the mind I've been given.

Purpose Isn't Always a Single Sentence

I've been treating purpose like a job title: one clear role, one clear mission, one clear deadline.

But maybe purpose is closer to a practice.

A series of choices made faithfully over time.

Maybe the point isn't to find one final answer and then stop moving. Maybe the point is to keep showing up—learning, healing, serving, noticing—until the light shifts and the next step appears.

And if that's true, then learning isn't a distraction from Jannah.

It's part of the path toward it.

Closing Thoughts

On the days my brain calls everything pointless, I want to remember this:

- I don't know which piece of knowledge will matter later.
- I don't know which skill will become service.
- I don't know which insight will become someone else's ease.

But I do know this:

God does not waste effort when it is offered sincerely.

So I will keep learning—not because the world is stable, but because the soul is meant to grow.

And when the time comes for what I've learned to be used, I trust it will be there.